

Solutions to exercises You should spend significant time on your own attempting the exercises in the “Try It Yourself” sections. However, if you’re stuck and can’t make any progress, solutions to most of the exercises are online.

Cheat sheets A full set of downloadable cheat sheets for quick reference to major concepts is also online.

Why Python?

Every year, I consider whether to continue using Python or move on to a different language, perhaps one that’s newer to the programming world. But I continue to focus on Python for many reasons. Python is an incredibly efficient language: your programs will do more in fewer lines of code than many other languages would require. Python’s syntax will also help you write “clean” code. Your code will be easier to read, easier to debug, and easier to extend and build upon, compared to other languages.

People use Python for many purposes: to make games, build web applications, solve business problems, and develop internal tools at all kinds of interesting companies. Python is also used heavily in scientific fields, for academic research and applied work.

One of the most important reasons I continue to use Python is because of the Python community, which includes an incredibly diverse and welcoming group of people. Community is essential to programmers because programming isn’t a solitary pursuit. Most of us, even the most experienced programmers, need to ask advice from others who have already solved similar problems. Having a well-connected and supportive community is critical to helping you solve problems, and the Python community is fully supportive of people who are learning Python as their first programming language or coming to Python with a background in other languages.

Python is a great language to learn, so let’s get started!